

Claude Code + Telegram Integration Guide

Quick Reference

This guide sets up a simple Telegram bot that lets you ask Claude Code questions and get responses directly in Telegram.

What you'll get:

- Quick Q&A with Claude via Telegram messages
- Voice message support (optional enhancement)
- Works alongside your Terminus SSH access
- Responses auto-truncate at 4000 chars with warning

Time to set up: 30 minutes

Prerequisites

- ✓ Claude Code installed on VPS (done!)
 - ✓ n8n running on VPS (done!)
 - ✓ Telegram app on your phone
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Part 1: Create Telegram Bot (10 minutes)

Step 1: Talk to BotFather

1. Open Telegram
2. Search for `@BotFather` (official bot with blue checkmark)
3. Start a chat and send: `/newbot`
4. Give it a name: `Claude Code Assistant` (or whatever you want)
5. Give it a username: `YourNameClaudeBot` (must end in "bot")
6. **Save the API token** - looks like: `123456789:ABCdefGHIjklMNOpqrsTUVwxyz`

Step 2: Get Your Telegram User ID

1. Search for `@userinfobot` in Telegram
2. Start a chat - it immediately shows your User ID
3. **Save your User ID** - looks like: `987654321`

This ensures only YOU can use the bot (security).

Part 2: Create n8n Workflow (20 minutes)

Step 3: Import Workflow to n8n

1. Open your n8n instance
2. Click **"Add workflow"** → **"Import from File"** or **"Import from URL"**
3. Use the JSON at the bottom of this document
4. The workflow will be imported with placeholder values

Step 4: Configure Telegram Trigger Node

Double-click the **"Telegram Trigger"** node:

1. **Create new credentials:**
 - Click "Create New Credentials"
 - Paste your Bot Token from BotFather
 - Save
2. **Set Updates to:**

Step 5: Configure Security Filter Node

Double-click the **"Filter: Only My Messages"** node:

1. In the conditions, replace with your actual user ID
2. This ensures only messages from you trigger Claude

Step 6: Configure SSH Node

Double-click the **"SSH: Execute Claude"** node:

1. **Create new credentials:**
 - Host: or
 - Port:
 - Username:
 - Authentication:
 - Password: Your VPS root password

- Save

2. Command field should be:

```
/root/.local/bin/claude "{{ $json.message.text }}"
```

Step 7: Configure Telegram Send Node

Double-click the "Telegram: Send Response" node:

1. Use the same Telegram credentials you created earlier
2. **Chat ID:** `{{ $json.message.chat.id }}`
3. **Message:** `{{ $json.response }}`
4. **Parse Mode:** `Markdown`

Step 8: Activate Workflow

1. Click "Active" toggle in top-right
2. Workflow is now live!

Part 3: Test It

Test 1: Basic Question

Open Telegram, message your bot:

```
What is n8n?
```

You should get a response from Claude within a few seconds.

Test 2: Code Question

```
What's the n8n expression to get today's date?
```

Test 3: Long Response (Testing Truncation)

```
Explain everything about n8n workflows in detail
```

Should get truncated with a warning at the end.

Usage Guidelines

✅ Good Use Cases for Telegram:

- Quick syntax questions
- Error explanations
- Short how-to questions
- Fact lookups
- "Does this expression look right?"

❌ Use Termius Instead For:

- Detailed explanations
- Code reviews
- Multi-step debugging
- Responses over 4000 characters
- Threading/conversation history

💡 Pro Tips:

- Keep questions concise
 - If response gets truncated, switch to Termius
 - You can still use threads - just reference them in your message: "In my debugging thread, what did we decide about..."
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Troubleshooting

Bot doesn't respond:

1. Check workflow is Active in n8n
2. Check Telegram credentials are correct
3. Check SSH credentials work (test SSH node manually in n8n)
4. Check Claude Code is still authenticated: SSH to VPS and run `claude "test"`

"Permission denied" error:

- SSH credentials might be wrong

- Try reconnecting to VPS and running: `claude "test"` manually

Response truncated too often:

- Adjust `MAX_LENGTH` in the Code node (currently 4000)
- Or just use Termius for those questions

Only you should be able to use it:

- The Filter node checks User ID
 - If others message the bot, they get ignored
 - No error message sent (silent ignore for security)
-

Optional Enhancements (Future)

Voice Message Support

Add a Telegram Trigger for voice messages:

- Trigger on `voice` message type
- Use n8n's speech-to-text (or external API)
- Pass text to Claude
- Send response back

Thread Management

Add command handling:

```
/thread new Project Planning  
/thread list  
/thread switch abc123
```

Parse these before sending to Claude.

File Upload Support

- Trigger on `document` message type
 - Save file to VPS temp location
 - Pass file path to Claude: `claude "review this file: /tmp/code.js"`
-

n8n Workflow JSON

Import this into n8n:

json

```
{
  "name": "Claude Code Telegram Bot",
  "nodes": [
    {
      "parameters": {
        "updates": [
          "message"
        ]
      },
      "name": "Telegram Trigger",
      "type": "n8n-nodes-base.telegramTrigger",
      "typeVersion": 1,
      "position": [
        240,
        300
      ],
      "webhookId": "GENERATED_BY_N8N",
      "credentials": {
        "telegramApi": {
          "id": "YOUR_TELEGRAM_CREDENTIALS_ID",
          "name": "Telegram Bot"
        }
      }
    },
    {
      "parameters": {
        "conditions": {
          "number": [
            {
              "value1": "={{ $json.message.from.id }}",
              "operation": "equal",
              "value2": "YOUR_TELEGRAM_USER_ID"
            }
          ]
        }
      },
      "name": "Filter: Only My Messages",
      "type": "n8n-nodes-base.if",
      "typeVersion": 1,
      "position": [
        460,
        300
      ]
    }
  ]
}
```

```

},
{
  "parameters": {
    "command": "=/root/.local/bin/claude \"{{ $json.message.text }}\""
  },
  "name": "SSH: Execute Claude",
  "type": "n8n-nodes-base.ssh",
  "typeVersion": 1,
  "position": [
    680,
    300
  ],
  "credentials": {
    "sshPassword": {
      "id": "YOUR_SSH_CREDENTIALS_ID",
      "name": "VPS SSH"
    }
  }
},
{
  "parameters": {
    "functionCode": "/// Handle response length\nconst response = $input.first().json.stdout || \"No response from Claude\";\n",
  },
  "name": "Code: Handle Response Length",
  "type": "n8n-nodes-base.code",
  "typeVersion": 2,
  "position": [
    900,
    300
  ]
},
{
  "parameters": {
    "chatId": "={{ $json.chat_id }}",
    "text": "={{ $json.response }}",
    "additionalFields": {
      "parse_mode": "Markdown"
    }
  },
  "name": "Telegram: Send Response",
  "type": "n8n-nodes-base.telegram",
  "typeVersion": 1,
  "position": [
    1120,

```



```
300
],
"credentials": {
  "telegramApi": {
    "id": "YOUR_TELEGRAM_CREDENTIALS_ID",
    "name": "Telegram Bot"
  }
}
},
"connections": {
  "Telegram Trigger": {
    "main": [
      [
        {
          "node": "Filter: Only My Messages",
          "type": "main",
          "index": 0
        }
      ]
    ]
  },
  "Filter: Only My Messages": {
    "main": [
      [
        {
          "node": "SSH: Execute Claude",
          "type": "main",
          "index": 0
        }
      ]
    ]
  },
  "SSH: Execute Claude": {
    "main": [
      [
        {
          "node": "Code: Handle Response Length",
          "type": "main",
          "index": 0
        }
      ]
    ]
  },
},
```

```
"Code: Handle Response Length": {
  "main": [
    [
      {
        "node": "Telegram: Send Response",
        "type": "main",
        "index": 0
      }
    ]
  ]
}
```

Security Notes

- Only your User ID can trigger the bot (Filter node)
 - Bot token should be kept secret
 - SSH credentials stored securely in n8n
 - Claude Code authentication persists on VPS
 - No data leaves your VPS except Telegram messages
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Questions?

If you run into issues:

1. Test each node manually in n8n (use "Execute Node" button)
 2. Check n8n execution logs
 3. SSH to VPS and test: `/root/.local/bin/claude "test"`
 4. Verify bot token and credentials
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Created: February 2026 **For:** Wayne's VPS (srv1063345) **Status:** Ready to implement when needed